

Vedas

a foundation of Indian Knowledge Systems.

- Vedas are the oldest religious texts of India.
- Known as shruti (heard knowledge)
- written between 1500 - 500 BCE.
- Language = Sanskrit

① Rig Veda

- Oldest Veda
- Contains prayers (hymns)
- Talk about gods (Agni, Indra)
- Written in Sanskrit.
- 1028 hymns (मंत्र)
- worship of god (Indra, Agni etc)
- 10600 Versa

② Yajur Veda (कर्मकाण्ड)

- About yajna (Sacrifices)
- Tells how to perform rituals.
- Used by priests.
- Practical worship guide.
- Shukla (white) Yajurveda
- Krishna (black) Yajurveda

③ Sama Veda (संगीत)

- Contain songs and chants (मंत्र, गीत)
- used for singing during rituals.
- Related to music.
- Taken from Rig Veda (mostly)
- 1875 Versa

④ Atharva Veda Daily life

- About daily life.
- Include medicine & healing.
- Contains Black magic & prayers.
- Show social & cultural life of people.
- 730 hymns
- Known as vedas of Magic Formula.
- Health related things (disease)
- Healing, protection, medicine etc.

Diagram

- | | |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <u>Rig Veda</u> | • Oldest, contain hymns of gods. |
| <u>Yajurveda</u> | • Rules of Sacrifices (Yajna) |
| <u>Samaveda</u> | • Related to music and chanting |
| <u>Atharvaveda</u> | • Deals with medicine & daily life. |

Parts of Vedas

- Samhita → Mantras
- Brahmana → Ritual Explanation
- Aranyaka → Forest texts.
- Upanishad → Philosophy.

Ramayana

- Ramayana is an ancient epic written by Valmiki.
- Main Story: Rama goes to Vanavash with his brother & her wife Sita, Sita kidnapped by Ravana, Rama Defeats Ravana with the help of "Bharat" 'Sena' and returns to Ayodhya with Sita.
- Main Characters:
 - Rama, (Ideal King), Sita (Ideal woman)
 - Laxhman (Loyal brother), Hanuman (Devotee)
 - Ravana (Villain)
- Lesson from Ramayana, Ramayana teaches ethics, values & ideal living
- ① Dharma (कर्तव्यपालन) → Always follow your duty, even in difficult situations.
- ② Trust & Honesty → Trust & Honesty leads to victory.
- ③ Respect of Elders & Parents → Rama Respect his Father.
- ④ Unity with Siblings
- ⑤ Good vs Evil → Good always defeats evil.
- ⑥ Sacrifice → Rama and Sita, Laxman Sacrifice the Kingdom.
- ⑦ Leadership → Rama is an ideal Leader & role model.
- ⑧ Greeds → Greed leads to trouble (Sita wants golden deer)

Mahabharata

- Mahabharata is an ancient epic written by Veda Vyasa.
 - Main Story: Conflict b/w pandavas & Kauravas leads to Kurukshetra war where pandavas win.
 - Main Characters:
 - * Pandavas (Yudhishthira, Arjun, Bhishma, Nakul, Sahadev)
 - * Kaurava (Duryodhan)
 - * Krishna (Guide)
 - * Draupadi
 - * Karna
 - Lessons:
 - ① Fight for what's yours.
 - ② Your ego will destroy everything.
 - ③ Choose Best & correct mentor
 - ④ We must leave the wrong place at right time.
 - ⑤ Don't take decision in Anger.
 - ⑥ Stay with useful peoples.
 - ⑦ Bad company Ruins Everything.
- Do your Duty (Dharma)
 - Karma (Good or bad)
 - gambling destroy everything.
 - Family conflict destroy everything
 - Respect for women.

Ramayana (Teachings)

① Dharma

- Always follow your duty, even it is difficult.
- Rama accepted 14 years of exile to respect his father's promise.

② Respect For parents & Elders.

- Obey and respect parents.
- Rama obeyed Dasharath without argument.

③ Ideal Relationships.

- Shows perfect roles in life.
- ideal son → Rama • ideal wife → Sita • ideal brother → Lakshmana

④ Good vs Evil

- Good always wins over evil.
- Rama defeated Ravana.

⑤ Ego destroy Everything.

- Ravan ego and greeds caused his downfall.

⑥ Loyalty and Friendship.

- True friends help in difficult times.
- Hanuman and Sugriva supported Rama.

⑦ Leadership & Responsibilities.

- A good leader always think about people first.
- Rama ruled ayodhya with justice (Ram Rajya)

⑧ Greeds

- ~~Sit~~ Greeds leads more difficulty in life.
- Sita greeds of golden deer.

Indian Languages :-

* Key to expressing thoughts and understanding culture.

Four Language Family.

- ① Aryan
- ② Dravidian
- ③ Sino Tibetan
- ④ Austric.

Evolution of Script / writing in India

* Evolution of script = Study of origin, development & importance of writing system in India.

Script :-

OR

* Script is a set of written symbol used to represent a language.

* It Helps us read, write and communication ideas.

Example ①-

- Language = English
 - Script = Roman (Alphabet : A, B, C, D, ...)
- we write English

Example ②

- Hindi Language → Devanagari script (अ, आ, इ, ई)
- Tamil Language → Tamil Script.
- Ancient Language → Brahmi Script.

Harappan Script

Earliest and Mysterious Script of India

Introduction

- Harappan Script is the Oldest script of India.
- It was used in Indus Valley Civilization. (2500-1900) BCE

Features

मिहरी के बर्तन

मस्तिशो

- Found on seals, pottery and tablets
- Uses symbols and pictographs.
- Around 400-600 Signs.
- Written from ~~left to right~~ right to left order.
- Mostly there ~~was~~ sentences was shorts. (writings)

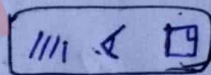
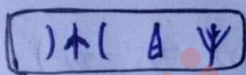
Nature:-

- It is undeciphered (not fully understood till present)
- Unknown language. (unreadable)

Importance

- Shows early writing system and communication.
- Gives knowledge about trade and culture.
- Important for history study.

Some Symbols of Harappan Script.



Seals.

Brahmi Script

→ Foundation of modern Indian scripts.

- Brahmi Script is the earliest readable script of India
- Developed around 3rd century BCE (Mauryan period)
- Also known as mother of Indian languages.

Feature:-

- written left to right
- contains clear letters.
- Simple & systematic.

Evolution

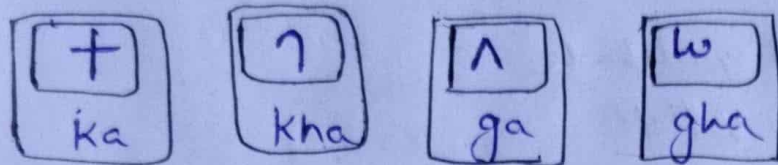
- Source of many scripts like Devanagari, Tamil, Telugu, Kannada.

- called mother of Indian scripts.

Importance

- Helps in understanding history
- Shows religion & cultures for next generation.
- Growth of education & literature.

Some Symbol of Brahmi Script.



Difference between Harappan & Brahmi Script.

Basis	Harappan	Brahmi Script.
Time	2500 - 1900 BCE	3rd Century BCE
Civilization	Indus valley civilization	Mauryan Period
Nature	Undeciphered	Deciphered
Writing styles	Symbols & pictographs	Proper Letter
Direction	Right to left ←	Left to Right. →
Length	Short texts	Longer inscriptions.
Language	Unknown	Prakrit (mainly)
Importance	Early writing systems	Base of modern scripts.
Examples	𑀩 𑀭 𑀮 𑀯 𑀰	𑀧 𑀘 𑀭

Upanishads

- Also known as Vedantas (end to vedas)
- It explained the vedas in simplest languages because vedas written in Sanskrit language, only Brahman can understand properly, Normal peoples faced some issue to get knowledge of vedas.
- So Upanishads shows the meaning of vedas in easy language.

- Upanishads are the concluding portion of the vedas.
- Focus on spiritual knowledge and philosophy.
- Discusses Atman (Soul) and Brahman (Universal reality)
- Knowledge leads to moksha.
- Based on guru-student tradition.
- No of upanishads = 108 upanishads
= 13 Valid
- Explain the purpose of life.
- Foundation of Indian philosophy.

Ex:- of some upanishads.

- * Isha, Prasna
- * Kena, Maitri
- * Katha
- * Mundaka ⇒ "Satyameva Jayate"

Purans

- Purans gives religious stories and moral teaching.
- Contains stories of gods, kings and world creation (etc)
- It explain the vedas in story form.
- Also explain history, culture and beliefs in a simple way.
- written mainly in Sanskrit.

Some purans

main content of purans

- Stories of Gods (like Vishnu, Shiva, Brahma)
- Creation of the universe.
- Stories of kings.
- Moral lessons (good vs bad)

- * Vishnu puran
- * Shiva puran
- * Bhagvat puran
- * Brahma puran
- * Garuda puran
- * Matsya puran
- * Agni "

Key Features

- 18 major purans
- written in story form
- Teach moral values
- Explain religion & traditions
- Made for common people

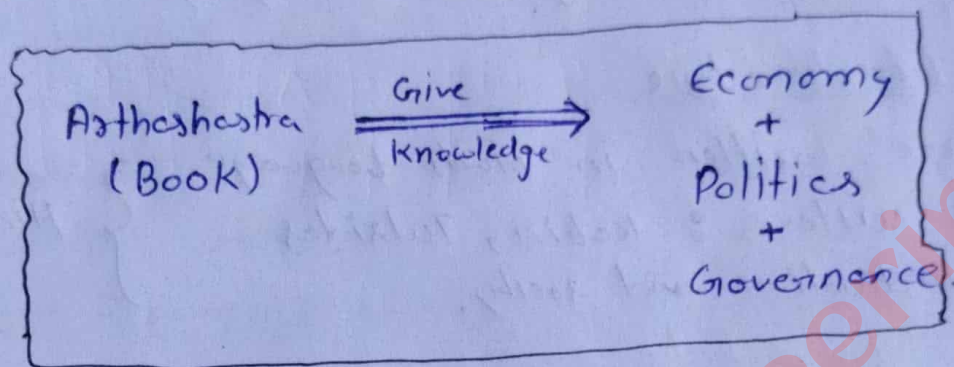
Importance

- Gives life lesson
- Help people to understand religion.

Kautilya Arthashastra

• Ancient Book by Kautilya that gives knowledge about Economy, politics.

- Arthashastra was written by Kautilya (Chanakya)
- It is all about politics, economy and administration
- written during Mauryan period.



main Topics

- * Governance of State
- * Taxation and economy.
- * Law and Justice
- * Spy system
- * war and foreign policy.

Key points

- Define Kings duties
- Show responsibility of Minister
- How tax system is important.
- How to spread your business. trade and agriculture.
- Use of spies

Importance

- * First Indian book on politics & economics
- * Useful even today.
- * Shows advanced knowledge of ancient India.

Some famous quotes

① "Education is the best friend"

meaning → knowledge always helps in life

② "Do not reveal (open) your secrets"

meaning → Be careful and smart

③ "The biggest guru-mantra is : Never share your weakness"

Literature (साहित्य)

- Literature means written knowledge and works
- Include religion, history, stories, poetry and philosophy.
- Shows culture, religion and language

Indian Literature type

- ① Literature written in Hindi Language.
 - Famous writers : Kabir, Tulsidas
 - Focus on devotion and society.
- } Hindi Literature

⑤ Kannada Literature

- Literature in Kannada language (Karnataka)
- Early work : ~~Kaveri~~ (Epic Book) Kavisraymanga.
- Include : Vachana poetry.

③ Buddhist Literature

- Literature of Buddhism.
- Main Book : Tripitaka
- Teaches : non-violence and middle path.

④ Jain Literature

- Literature of Jainism.
- Main text : Agamas
- Teaches : non-violence and truth.

⑤ Sangam Literature

- Ancient Tamil Literature of South India.
- Describe life, love, and war.
- Very old (200 BCE - 200 CE).

⑥ Telugu Literature

- written in telugu language.
- started around 11th century.
- Based on : religion, devotion and history

⑦ Malayalam Literature

- written in malayalam languages (Kerala), 12th century
- Focus on : society, devotion & culture